

PBS Freshie Presentation

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Disclaimer

Although I'm speaking on behalf of PBS. The views expressed in this presentation are in my personal capacity and may not reflect those of PBS.

- Plant Based Society is a registered ISB at IITM.
- Founded in February 2023.
- By four Scholars/Students and a few interns/exchange students.

Agenda

- We raise awareness on animal welfare/rights, and plant-based living.
- You might have heard about Veganism, we try to promote vegan lifestyles.

Motivation

- The core motivation is as follows: **It is deeply unethical to seriously harm sentient beings for trivial reasons such as taste, pleasure, habit, or convenience**
- It is also similarly problematic to pay others to harm sentient beings on our behalf.
- And, whenever we try to take any product/service from animals, we almost always have to mistreat (read as torture) them.
- Therefore, using animal products/services for trivial reasons is unethical.
- And obviously, we should not do unethical things.

- Turns out, we harm the most number of animals for food (98+%), followed by clothing, entertainment, and research.
- So, if you buy the argument on the previous slide, and you don't have any honest non-trivial reasons, you are morally required to make some lifestyle changes.
- The new lifestyle would be such that you don't buy animal products/services for trivial reasons.

Objection 1

- **But, isn't it my personal choice what I consume or not?**
- It is your definitely your personal choice, but it is not your personal matter.
- If there were a cat sitting here peacefully, it is my personal choice to move my leg around and kick it. But is not my personal matter, as there is a victim involved, the poor cat.

Objection 2

- **What about nutrition/protein? Is Vegan diet nutritiously adequate?**
- Fortunately, it is. We have established research confirming that a fully plant-based diet is perfectly adequate for all ages/gender/demographics.
- Plant Based diet lacks Vit B12. So, you'll have to supplement that. We make B12 from from algae.
- Most Indians are anyway B12 deficient, so it's a good thing you supplement that, even if you're not vegan.

Objection 3

- **But Plants also feel pain!**
- It is unclear whether plants *feel* pain.
- Plants certainly respond to stimuli but that's different from pain.
- Also, plants lack CNS, so it is unlikely they **suffer**.
- But even if I grant you that plants do suffer. It would still make sense to consume plants.
- This is because most crops are grown to feed animals which we then consume.
- This conversion of energy from plants to animals is inefficient and we end up killing lot more plants than we otherwise would.

Moving on

- You may come with many such arguments.
- But, I encourage you to think critically or search up their counters online.
- It is difficult to argue against the central idea of Veganism.
- And I understand that the conclusion of the idea is pretty demanding.

What can I do if I can't go Vegan?

- Try as much as you can.
- Each time you avoid an animal product/service, think of it as saving a life.
- Talk to your friends/family about the idea and try to convince them.
- At least, don't encourage them to try out more animal products if they already don't.
- You may also think about offsetting your purchases.
- There are highly effective charities working to save/improve animals' lives.
- And money donated to such charities goes pretty far.

Moving on to PBS

- To achieve the goals mentioned in agenda/motivation, we conduct various events.
- Our most successful events are Outreaches where we set up a small stall and just talk to people in a structured manner.
- We also host speaker talks. We've hosted Acharya Prashant, Arvind Animal Activist, and Dr. Shailesh Rao.
- Many more speaker talks are planned for this semester and the following.
- We also conduct documentary screenings/ essay writing competitions.
- You may give us more event ideas by joining the team :)

Joining PBS

- We have a recruitment season coming up in the next couple weeks, so stay tuned.
- You may anyway email us at pbs@smail.iitm.ac.in
- Or follow/dm on instagram at [plantbasedsociety_iitm](https://www.instagram.com/plantbasedsociety_iitm)

A question for you

If AI goes well for humans, will it also go well the animals?

Thank you

Thank you so much for your attention and time.
Please be compassionate to all beings.